Troop Leading Procedure (TLP)

Quick briefing

Use the eight Troop Leading Procedure steps to organize preparation time, inform subordinates early, and refine the plan as facts change.

Know the facts

Eight steps · Receive the mission, issue a warning order, make a tentative plan, initiate movement, conduct reconnaissance, complete the plan, issue the order, and supervise and refine.

Reverse planning · Work backward from the ready time. The one-third/two-thirds guideline preserves roughly two-thirds of available time for subordinate planning and preparation.

Warning order · Gives subordinates enough known information to start preparing and identifies when and where to expect the full order, when known.

Mission analysis · Identify specified tasks, infer necessary implied tasks, and restate the mission with a purpose tied to the higher objective.

Reconnaissance and refinement · Check information gaps that could alter the tentative plan. Use backbriefs, rehearsals, and inspections to test the completed plan and correct problems.

Understand the reasoning

The steps overlap in the worked example. Early warning and authorized preparation protect subordinate time while the leader continues to analyze the mission.

An information gap is worth pursuing when the answer could change a decision. Prioritize that gap over details that would only make the briefing longer.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

A Philippine Army classroom group has three hours before a demonstration must be ready. The lead student is waiting for confirmation of one venue detail, but the other sections can already gather materials and assign roles.

Decision · What should the lead student communicate now, and how should the group use the remaining time?

Worked analysis · Issue a warning order with the purpose, known tasks, ready time, and expected full briefing. Let sections begin authorized preparation while someone verifies the venue detail. Aim to give subordinates about two hours to prepare and use the final checks to catch any effect of the venue change.

How to practice

1 · On receiving the mission, work backward from the required ready time and budget subordinate preparation time.

2 · Issue a warning order with known tasks, immediate preparation, and the next briefing time if available.

3 · Develop a tentative plan from the mission and compare feasible courses of action.

4 · Begin authorized movement or other early preparation as applicable and verify the information gaps that could change the plan.

5 · Complete and issue the order, including the coordinating information subordinates need.

6 · Use backbriefs, checks, and rehearsals to supervise preparation and refine the plan.

Check yourself

What is the difference between a specified task and an implied task? · A specified task appears in the higher order. An implied task is inferred as necessary to carry it out.

What does the one-third/two-thirds guideline protect? · Time for subordinate leaders and their teams to plan and prepare.

Course source

Troop Leading Procedure · Worked Classroom Exercise